SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

5 September 2023 · Shift 3

44 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 46 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 19 questions

Q.1

How many elements are listed in the modern periodic table?

(A) 107
(B) 81
(C) 91
(D) 118

Q.2

In which of the following States was the third edition of Khelo India University Games held?

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) New Delhi
(D) Punjab

Q.3

Which country did India beat in the final to win the 2023 Intercontinental Cup Football championship?

(A) Thailand
(B) Lebanon
(C) Mongolia
(D) Vanuatu

Q.4

In which state of India is shifting cultivation known as Bringa?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Manipur
(C) Odisha
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.5

What does the acronym ‘ATM’ stand for?

(A) Automated Teller Machine
(B) Automated Transaction Management
(C) Account Tracking Module
(D) All-Time Money

Q.6

Who had founded the first Women’s University in India?

(A) Dhondo Keshav Karve
(B) Ashutosh Mukherjee
(C) William Hunter
(D) Sayed Ahmed Khan

Q.7

Devendra Jhajharia won which medal/place in World Para Athletics Grand Prix?

(A) Bronze
(B) Gold
(C) Silver
(D) Fourth

Q.8

In the process of cell division, the formation of phragmoplast between the two daughter nuclei occurs during:

(A) the G0 phase
(B) the cytokinesis
(C) the S phase
(D) the karyokinesis

Q.9

In which type of forests are Mahogany, Rosewood and Cinchona trees found in India?

(A) Tropical Evergreen forests
(B) Tropical Deciduous forests
(C) Mangrove forests
(D) Montane forests

Q.10

Lebang Boomani dance is the harvest dance of _____.

(A) Mizoram
(B) Tripura
(C) Assam
(D) Meghalaya

Q.12

Which of the following is NOT a directive principle of state policy?

(A) Separation of the judiciary from executive
(B) Reside in any part of India
(C) Uniform civil code
(D) Protection of monuments

Q.13

In which state is the Sanchi Stupa situated?

(A) Bihar
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Gujarat
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.15

Who among the following is the author of the book, ‘Unfinished: A Memoir’?

(A) Alia Bhatt
(B) Priyanka Chopra
(C) Deepika Padukone
(D) Kareena Kapoor

Q.17

The official language of which neighbouring country of India is ‘Dhivehi'?

(A) Maldives
(B) Sri Lanka
(C) Bhutan
(D) China

Q.18

Under which scheme of Airport Authority of India did the Jammu and Kashmir Lieutenant Governor inaugurate UMEED Market Place at Srinagar international airport for supporting local art and artisans of Self Help Groups of J&K Rural Livelihood Mission?

(A) AVSAR Scheme
(B) AKASH Scheme
(C) AAKAR Scheme
(D) ASAR Scheme

Q.19

Who was the Iranian ruler who attacked the city of Delhi and took away an immense amount of wealth in 1739?

(A) Ahmad Shah Qajar
(B) Nadir Shah
(C) Ahmad Shah Abdali
(D) Abbas I

Q.21

Mahari Dance and Gotipua Dance belongs to which of the following states?

(A) Odisha
(B) Haryana
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Bihar

Q.23

Which of the following musicians is popularly known as 'Panchamda'?

(A) Ravi
(B) Khayam
(C) Naushad
(D) RD Burman

Q.24

The 'Mukteshwar' dance festival is held from 14th to 16th January at the Mukteshwar temple in the state of _____.

(A) Uttarakhand
(B) Odisha
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Himachal Pradesh

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. "For an all-too-brief" period "between the late" 1980s and the late 2000s, "a world was" "characterised by" convergence.

(A) between the late
(B) For an all-too-brief
(C) characterised by
(D) a world was

Q.2

The sentence given below has spelling errors. Select the sentence without spelling errors. Let us appriciate, support and contribute our might to the promotional efforts of the community in this direction.

(A) Let us appriciate, support and contribute our might to the promotional efforts of the comunity in this direction.
(B) Let us appreciate, suport and contribute our might to the promotional efforts of the community in this direction.
(C) Let us appriciate, support and contribute our might to the promotion all efforts of the community in this direction.
(D) Let us appreciate, support and contribute our might to the promotional efforts of the community in this direction.

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The team had a _____ with respect to the proposal given by Mr. Albert.

(A) descussion
(B) discusion
(C) disckassion
(D) discussion

Q.4

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A thing which happens every two years

(A) Century
(B) Annual
(C) Biennial
(D) Bi-monthly

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the following sentence. Ramya's shoes "are polish" by her granddaughter.

(A) polishes
(B) had polished
(C) are polished
(D) is polish

Q.6

Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. I don't think you should go out in the rain, it's _____.

(A) rain on cats and dogs
(B) storming cats and dogs
(C) raining cats and dogs
(D) raining dogs and puppies

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To keep one's temper

(A) To meet with disaster
(B) To become impatient
(C) To become angry
(D) To remain calm

Q.8

Select the correct spelling of the underlined word in the following sentence. Today's lecture had a "profond" impact on my friend.

(A) profoun
(B) prufound
(C) prefound
(D) profound

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. To get cold feet

(A) To be afraid
(B) To fall sick
(C) To be indifferent
(D) To run for life

Q.10

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word. His "amazing" performance made him famous.

(A) Ordinary
(B) Colliery
(C) Adversary
(D) Binary

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The food was too salty "eat" this morning.

(A) eating
(B) ate
(C) to ate
(D) to eat

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Elegant

(A) Mighty
(B) Graceful
(C) Ugly
(D) Tall

Q.13

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. I "will going" "on" "an official tour" "next week."

(A) on
(B) will going
(C) next week
(D) an official tour

Q.14

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Shelley and Keats are great writers, but I prefer the last.

(A) the last
(B) are great writers
(C) but I prefer
(D) Shelley and Keats

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Design

(A) Fabricate
(B) Destroy
(C) Inspect
(D) Copy

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. A person who is known for his hatred towards the entire mankind.

(A) Insolvent
(B) Philogynist
(C) Mercenary
(D) Misanthrope

Q.17

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. Jaya said that she will become topper in her class.

(A) in her class
(B) she will become topper
(C) that
(D) Jaya said

Q.18

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Some / private banks / pay their employees / good.

(A) private banks
(B) Some
(C) pay their employees
(D) good

Q.19

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Break the ice

(A) To say something that makes strangers uncomfortable
(B) To say something that makes people who are meeting for the first time more comfortable
(C) To say something that makes people excited for a group project
(D) To say something mean to people in a group

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase. A poem of lamentation on the death of someone loved and admired.

(A) Soliloquy
(B) Elegy
(C) Tragedy
(D) Epitaph

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is (1)_____ of the most fundamental aspects of human communication and interaction. It allows people from different cultures to connect and (2) _____ ideas. While many individuals grow up learning just one language, there are a variety of reasons why learning a second language can be beneficial. (3) _____, it can improve cognitive abilities, enhance job prospects and facilitate travel and cultural immersion. (4)_____ proficiency in a second language is an invaluable asset for personal growth as well as professional development. Audio-video mediums such as (5)_____ are among the best ways to learn a second language as they allow learners to engage with cultural content.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) three
(B) four
(C) two
(D) one

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is (1)_____ of the most fundamental aspects of human communication and interaction. It allows people from different cultures to connect and (2) _____ ideas. While many individuals grow up learning just one language, there are a variety of reasons why learning a second language can be beneficial. (3) _____, it can improve cognitive abilities, enhance job prospects and facilitate travel and cultural immersion. (4)_____ proficiency in a second language is an invaluable asset for personal growth as well as professional development. Audio-video mediums such as (5)_____ are among the best ways to learn a second language as they allow learners to engage with cultural content.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) sharing
(B) share
(C) shares
(D) shared

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is (1)_____ of the most fundamental aspects of human communication and interaction. It allows people from different cultures to connect and (2) _____ ideas. While many individuals grow up learning just one language, there are a variety of reasons why learning a second language can be beneficial. (3) _____, it can improve cognitive abilities, enhance job prospects and facilitate travel and cultural immersion. (4)_____ proficiency in a second language is an invaluable asset for personal growth as well as professional development. Audio-video mediums such as (5)_____ are among the best ways to learn a second language as they allow learners to engage with cultural content.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) Therefore
(B) As it is
(C) However
(D) For example

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is (1)_____ of the most fundamental aspects of human communication and interaction. It allows people from different cultures to connect and (2) _____ ideas. While many individuals grow up learning just one language, there are a variety of reasons why learning a second language can be beneficial. (3) _____, it can improve cognitive abilities, enhance job prospects and facilitate travel and cultural immersion. (4)_____ proficiency in a second language is an invaluable asset for personal growth as well as professional development. Audio-video mediums such as (5)_____ are among the best ways to learn a second language as they allow learners to engage with cultural content.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) Acquiring
(B) Acquires
(C) Acquire
(D) Acquired

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Language is (1)_____ of the most fundamental aspects of human communication and interaction. It allows people from different cultures to connect and (2) _____ ideas. While many individuals grow up learning just one language, there are a variety of reasons why learning a second language can be beneficial. (3) _____, it can improve cognitive abilities, enhance job prospects and facilitate travel and cultural immersion. (4)_____ proficiency in a second language is an invaluable asset for personal growth as well as professional development. Audio-video mediums such as (5)_____ are among the best ways to learn a second language as they allow learners to engage with cultural content.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) podcasts

(B) images

(C) books

(D) films

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.24 **(B)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) 118

The modern periodic table lists 118 elements, up to oganesson (atomic number 118); the last four were named in 2016.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Uttar Pradesh

The third Khelo India University Games were held in Uttar Pradesh in May-June 2023, with Lucknow and Varanasi among the host cities.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Lebanon

India beat Lebanon 2-0 in the final of the 2023 Intercontinental Cup at Bhubaneswar in June 2023.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Odisha

Shifting (slash-and-burn) cultivation is called 'Pama Dabi', 'Koman' or 'Bringa' in Odisha, 'Podu' in Andhra Pradesh, 'Bewar' or 'Dahiya' in Madhya Pradesh and 'Jhum' in the north-east.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Automated Teller Machine

ATM stands for Automated Teller Machine, which lets a bank's customers withdraw cash and check balances without a bank clerk.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Dhondo Keshav Karve

Dhondo Keshav Karve founded India's first women's university, the Indian Women's University (now SNDT Women's University), in Pune in 1916.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Silver

SSC's key gives silver: at the World Para Athletics Grand Prix in Morocco in September 2022 Jhajharia took silver in the men's F46 javelin with 60.97 m, behind Ajeet Singh. The question does not name the meeting.

Q.8 · Answer (B) the cytokinesis

The phragmoplast forms in a dividing plant cell during cytokinesis, the division of the cytoplasm; it guides the building of the cell plate between the two daughter nuclei.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Tropical Evergreen forests

Ebony, mahogany, rosewood, rubber and cinchona are the commercially important trees of India's tropical evergreen forests.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Tripura

Lebang Boomani is a harvest dance of the Tripuri people of Tripura.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Reside in any part of India

The right to reside and settle in any part of India is a Fundamental Right, Article 19(1)(e). A uniform civil code (Article 44), protection of monuments (Article 49) and separation of the judiciary from the executive (Article 50) are Directive Principles.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Madhya Pradesh

The Great Stupa at Sanchi, begun under Asoka in the 3rd century BC, stands in Raisen district, Madhya Pradesh.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Priyanka Chopra

'Unfinished: A Memoir' (2021) is the actor Priyanka Chopra Jonas's memoir.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Maldives

Dhivehi is the official language of the Maldives.

Q.18 · Answer (A) AVSAR Scheme
The UMEED Market Place at Srinagar airport, opened by Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha in August 2022, came under the Airports Authority of India's AVSAR scheme (Airport as Venue for Skilled Artisans of the Region), which gives artisans and Self Help Groups space at airports to sell their products.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Nadir Shah
Nadir Shah of Persia sacked Delhi in 1739, in Muhammad Shah's reign, and carried away immense wealth, including the Peacock Throne and the Koh-i-Noor.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Odisha
Both are dances of Odisha: Mahari was danced by the devadasis of the Jagannath temple at Puri, and in Gotipua young boys dressed as girls perform; both fed into Odissi.

Q.23 · Answer (D) RD Burman
The film composer Rahul Dev (R. D.) Burman, son of S. D. Burman, was known as 'Pancham' or 'Panchamda'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Odisha
The Mukteswar Dance Festival, mainly of Odissi, is held every January at the 10th-century Mukteswar temple in Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (D) a world was
There is only one world, so it takes the definite article: 'the world was characterised by convergence'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Let us appreciate, support and contribute our might to the promotional efforts of the community in this direction.
Only this sentence spells 'appreciate', 'support', 'promotional' and 'community' correctly.

Q.3 · Answer (D) discussion
The correct spelling is 'discussion'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Biennial
'Biennial' means happening every two years; 'annual' is every year, and 'bi-monthly' every two months or twice a month.

Q.5 · Answer (C) are polished
The passive takes 'be' with the past participle: 'Ramya's shoes are polished by her granddaughter.'

Q.6 · Answer (C) raining cats and dogs
It is 'raining cats and dogs' when it is raining very heavily.

Q.7 · Answer (D) To remain calm
To 'keep one's temper' is to stay calm and not become angry.

Q.8 · Answer (D) profound
The correct spelling is 'profound'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) To be afraid
To 'get cold feet' is to become nervous or afraid about something one had planned to do.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Ordinary
'Amazing' means causing great surprise or wonder; its opposite is 'ordinary'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) to eat
'Too' with an adjective is followed by the to-infinitive: 'too salty to eat'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Graceful
'Elegant' means stylish and refined in manner or appearance: 'graceful'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) will going
'Will' takes the bare infinitive, so 'will going' should be 'will be going' (or 'will go').

Q.14 · Answer (A) the last
Of two persons the second is 'the latter', not 'the last': 'but I prefer the latter'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Fabricate
SSC's key gives 'fabricate': to 'design' is to devise or plan how something is to be made, and 'fabricate' (to devise, construct or make) is the only option close to it; 'destroy' is nearly the opposite, and 'inspect' and 'copy' do not mean this.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Misanthrope
A 'misanthrope' dislikes humankind in general; a philogynist loves women and an insolvent cannot pay their debts.

Q.17 · Answer (B) she will become topper
After the past reporting verb 'said', 'will' becomes 'would', and 'topper' needs the article: 'she would become the topper in her class'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) good
The verb 'pay' is modified by the adverb 'well', not the adjective 'good': 'pay their employees well'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) To say something that makes people who are meeting for the first time more comfortable
To 'break the ice' is to say or do something that relaxes people meeting for the first time.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Elegy
An 'elegy' is a poem of mourning for someone who has died; an epitaph is the inscription on a tomb, and a soliloquy a speech to oneself.

Q.21 · Answer (D) one
Language is a single subject ('is'), so it is 'one of the most fundamental aspects'; 'two', 'three' or 'four' of them cannot describe one thing.

Q.22 · Answer (B) share
'Share' is joined by 'and' to 'connect', so it takes the same base form after 'to': 'to connect and share ideas'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) For example
The sentence goes on to list the benefits of a second language, so it is introduced by 'For example'.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Acquiring
The subject of the sentence is the gerund phrase 'Acquiring proficiency in a second language'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) films
Films have both sound and pictures, so they are audio-video mediums; podcasts are sound only, and books and images have no sound.

This paper online, with tap-to-reveal answers: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-mts/question-papers/mts-2023-5-sep-2023-shift-3/
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